



KIAN RAVAEI

**ALL THE SOUNDS
AROUND HER**

for SSA chorus and
string orchestra

(full score)

ÆI edition

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AROUND HER**

for SSA chorus and
string orchestra

(full score)
(2024)

Overture1

I. Call and Response2

II. Counting Game.....12

III. Ella.....24

*Commissioned by Hoff-Barthelson Music School in association with
Copland House for the School's 2025 Music of Our Time Festival.*

First performance on May 18, 2025.

INSTRUMENTATION

SSA Chorus

3 Percussion*

Cabasa

Cowbell

Bongos

Strings (minimum 4,4,3,2,1)

*Percussion may be played by
members of the chorus.

PROGRAM NOTE

All The Sounds Around Her is a personal tribute to Ella Jenkins, whose many albums of children's songs have brought multicultural understanding to generations of young people. When I started writing this piece, it was to celebrate her 100th birthday, but in the midst of composition she passed away unexpectedly. I decided to embrace the original celebratory intent, allowing her legacy of joy and connection to remain at the heart of the music.

The first movement, which follows an instrumental overture, incorporates Jenkins's signature call-and-response singing as well as her tradition of writing lyrics that evoke both work songs and children's tunes. Drawing on my experience as a member of the UCLA Latin Jazz Big Band, I incorporated elements of Afro-Cuban music, one of her major musical influences.

"Counting Game," the second movement, invokes one of her favorite activities: counting from one to ten in different languages. Each language in this movement is one that Jenkins taught.

The final movement is a meditation on her name, drawing on a refrain from Dr. Ty-Juana Taylor's children's book *A Life of Song, The Story of Ella Jenkins*: "Ella soaked up all the sounds around her."

—Kian Ravaei

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to my musical mentors, colleagues, and collaborators, all of whom were essential in the creation of this work: Austin Ali, Madeline Barrett, Valerie Coleman, Dr. Paul De Castro, Amanda Gundling, Dr. Bobby Rodriguez, and Peter Seidenberg.

duration ca. 11'

ANALYSIS

The first movement incorporates elements of Afro-Cuban music, inspired by Ella Jenkins’s studies with Cuban Latin jazz percussionist Armando Peraza. To compose this movement, I drew on my own studies with Dr. Bobby Rodriguez and Dr. Paul De Castro as a member of the UCLA Latin Jazz Big Band.

Beginning in measure 5, the strings play the montuno, a syncopated accompaniment pattern. The tumbao, a syncopated bass pattern, appears in the cellos in measure 47. The 3-2 clave pattern is gradually built up over the first 17 measures, finally appearing in the cowbell at measure 18. It is a hybrid between the son and rumba claves, sometimes called a *Chitlins Con Carne* clave because of its appearance in the song “Chitlins Con Carne” by Kenny Burrell. The lyrics are roughly based on Jenkins’s song “Who Fed the Chickens?”

TEXT

Overture (Chorus Tacet)

I. Call and Response

Text by Kian Ravaei, with excerpts from “I’ve Been Working on the Railroad.”

Hey-o,
Who brought the bread?
Who checked the chickens?
Who shut the shed?

Hey-o,
Who stirred the soup?
Who tamed the turkeys?
Who cleaned the coop?

All the live-long day,
Pass the time away,
Early in the morn’.

Hey-o,
Who made the milk?
Who called the cattle?
Who sewed the silks?

Hey-o,
Who prepped the pie?
Who fed the felines?
Who scrubbed the sty?

All the live-long day,
Pass the time away,
Early in the morn’.

II. Counting Game

Text by Kian Ravaei

English	one	two	three	four	five	six	seven	eight	nine	ten
Hindi	ek	do	teen	chār	pānch	che	sāt	āt	no	das
Mandarin	ee	ār	sān	sü	oo	lyo	chee	bā	jyo	shi
Japanese	ee-chee	nee	san	yon	go	ro-koo	shee-chee	ha-chee	kyü	jü
Yiddish	eyns	tsvey	drāy	feer	finf	zeks	zeebn	ākht	nāyn	tsen
Hebrew	ā-khāt	shtāym	shā-losh	ār-bā	khā-mesh	shesh	she-vā	shmo-ne	te-shā	ē-ser
Polish	ye-den	dvā	che	chte-re	pyench	shesht	she-dem	o-shem	je-vench	je-shench
German	āynz	zvāy	drāy	veer	fünf	zeks	zee-bin	ākht	noyn	tsen
Spanish	oo-no	dos	tres	kwāt-ro	seenk-o	seys	sye-te	o-cho	nwe-ve	dyes
Italian	oo-no	doo-e	tre	kwāt-ro	cheen-qwe	sey	se-te	o-to	no-ve	dye-chi
French	uh	dü	twā	kat	sank	sees	set	weet	nuhf	dees
Malay	sā-too	doo-wā	tee-gā	uhm-pāt	lee-mā	uh-nām	too-jo	lā-pān	suhm-bee-lān	suh-poo-lo
Greek	e-nuh	thee-yo	tree-yuh	te-se-ruh	pen-te	ek-see	ep-tuh	ok-to	e-ney-uh	the-kuh
Swahili	mo-jā	bee-lee	tā-too	n-ne	tā-no	see-tā	sā-bā	nā-ne	tee-sā	koo-mee

III. Ella

Text by Ty-Juana Taylor*

Ella,
Ella,
Ella,
Soaked up all the sounds around her.

*From *A Life of Song: The Story of Ella Jenkins (The First Lady of Children’s Music)* by Ty-Juana Taylor published by Gloo Books, Copyright © 2024. Reproduced by permission of Gloo Books.

TRANSLITERATION PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Vowels	Consonants
a = ma <u>t</u>	g = ga <u>m</u> e
ā = fa <u>ll</u>	j = jo <u>y</u>
e = ne <u>t</u>	kh = “ch” in the German word <i>Bach</i> (voiceless uvular fricative)
ee = ke <u>en</u>	y = ya <u>r</u>
ey = he <u>y</u>	(All remaining consonants are the same as in English.)
i = bi <u>t</u>	
o = bo <u>w</u> l	
oo = po <u>o</u> l	
ü = <u>ü</u> ber (German) (“ee” with rounded lips)	
uh = br <u>u</u> h	

NB: The transliterations only approximate the original pronunciation. It is therefore recommended to listen to native speakers pronounce each word.

to the memory of Ella Jenkins

ALL THE SOUNDS AROUND HER

Kian Ravaei &
Ty-Juana Taylor

Kian Ravaei
(2024)

Overture

Broadly, warm ♩ = 60

Soprano 1

Soprano 2

Alto

Violin 1

Violin 2

Viola

Violoncello

Contrabass

pp

p dolce

pp

p dolce

p dolce

p dolce

8

rit.

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

p dolce

mf

p

mf espr.

pp

mf

p sub.

mf espr.

pp

mf

p sub.

mf espr.

p

mf espr.

attacca

I. Call and Response

Mambo (but not too fast) $\text{♩} = 80$

Cabasa

Cowbell

Bongos

Solo

Soprano 1

Soprano 2

Alto

Violin 1

Violin 2

Viola

Violoncello

Contrabass

8

A

Cab.

C.B.

Bon.

Solo

S 1

S 2

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

15

Cab.

C.B.

Bon.

S1

S2

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

mf

f

mf

p

22

B

Cab.

C.B.

Bon.

Solo

S1

S2

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

f

p

solo 1 *mf*

Hey - o

Who_ brought the bread?

Who

mf

Hey - o

Who_ brought the bread?

mf

Hey - o

Who_ brought the bread?

mf

Hey - o

Who_ brought the bread?

B

f

pp

non div.

f

pp

f

pp

f

pp

f

pp



51

Cab. $\frac{2}{\#}$

C.B. $\frac{2}{\#}$

Bon. $\frac{2}{\#}$

Solo

Ear - ly in the morn' -

S1 *mf* Pass the time a - way

S2 *mf* All the live-long day, Pass the time a - way

A *mf* All the live-long day

solo unis.

gli altri unis.

Vn. 1 *p*

Vn. 2 *p*

Va. *p*

Vc. *p*

Cb. *p*

57

Cab. $\frac{2}{\cancel{\#}}$

C.B. $\frac{2}{\cancel{\#}}$

Bon. $\frac{2}{\cancel{\#}}$

S1 *f* Ear - ly in__ the morn'__

S2 *f* Ear - ly in__ the morn' morn'__

A *f* Ear - ly in__ the morn' morn'__

Vn. 1 *f*

Vn. 2 *f*

Va. *f*

Vc. *f*

Cb. *f*

63

E

Cab.

Bon.

Solo

S1

S2

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

f

p

mf

Hey - o

Who__ made the milk?

Who

mf

Hey - o

Who__ made the milk?

mf

Hey - o

Who__ made the milk?

mf

Hey - o

Who__ made the milk?

pp

pp

f

f

arco

f

pp

pp



68

2

2

2

Cab.

C.B.

Bon.

Solo

S1

S2

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

p

__ called the cat - tle?

Who sewed the silks?

Hey - o

Who

Who_ called the cat - tle?

Who_ sewed the silks?

Hey - o

Who_ called the cat - tle?

Who_ sewed the silks?

Hey - o

Who_ called the cat - tle?

Who_ sewed the silks?

Hey - o

p

p

p

p

p

p

74

Cab. $\frac{2}{\#}$

C.B. $\frac{2}{\#}$

Bon. $\frac{2}{\#}$

Solo

mf

—prepped the pie? Who— fed the fe - lines?

S 1

Who prepped the pie? Hey - o Who scrubbed the sty,— the sty? *ff*

S 2

Who prepped the pie? Hey - o Who scrubbed the sty,— the sty? *ff*

A

Who prepped the pie? Hey - o Who scrubbed the sty,— the sty? *ff*

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

f



80 **F**

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

f *mf* *mf* *espr.* *p*



88

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

mf *p* *mf* *sharp*

95

G

S 2

p

Mm

A

p

Mm

Mm

Mm

Vn. 1

p

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.



102

S 1

p

Ooh

Ooh

S 2

Mm

Ooh

Ooh

A

Mm

Ooh

Ooh

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

p

108

Cab.

C.B.

Bon.

120

Solo

Pass the time a - way__ Ear - ly in__ the morn'__

S1

__ Pass the time a - way__ Ear - ly in__ the morn'__

S2

__ Pass the time a - way__ Ear - ly in__ the morn'__

A

__ Pass the time a - way__ Ear - ly in__ the morn'__

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

rit.

tutti, unis.

f

pp

Jam out ♩ = 120

128

Cab. **f** **2** **2** **2**

C.B. **f** add fills ad lib., take a solo

Bon. **f**

Jam out ♩ = 120

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

138

Cab. $\frac{2}{4}$ $\frac{2}{4}$ *pp*

C.B. $\frac{2}{4}$ $\frac{2}{4}$ *pp*

Bon. $\frac{2}{4}$ $\frac{2}{4}$ *pp*

Vn. 1 *p*

Vn. 2 *p*

Vc. *p*

attacca

II. Counting Game

Moderato sostenuto, in a Baroque style $\text{♩} = 60$

Each number assigned to a different soloist (10 soloists per section) until bar 19
(Ossia: sing every number tutti)

Each number assigned to a different soloist (10 soloists per section) until bar 19
(Ossia: sing every number tutti)

mf solo 1 solo 2 solo 3 (sim.)

Soprano

One two three four five six se - ven eight

mf solo 1 solo 2 solo 3 (sim.)

Alto

One two three four five six se - ven eight nine ten One two three four five six se - ven

Moderato sostenuto, in a Baroque style ♩ = 60

Violin 1

Violin 2

mf

Viola

mf

Violoncello

Contrabass

This musical score is for a piece titled "The Numbers Song". It is arranged for vocal soloists (Soprano and Alto) and a string ensemble (Violins 1 & 2, Viola, Violoncello, and Contrabass). The score is divided into two systems, each containing six measures. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 3/2. The tempo is marked "Moderato".

System 1:

- Measure 1:** Soprano: "nine", Alto: "eight nine ten".
- Measure 2:** Soprano: "ten", Alto: "One".
- Measure 3:** Soprano: "One", Alto: "two".
- Measure 4:** Soprano: "two", Alto: "three four five".
- Measure 5:** Soprano: "three four five", Alto: "six".
- Measure 6:** Soprano: "six", Alto: "se - ven eight nine".

System 2:

- Measure 7:** Soprano: "ten", Alto: "ten".
- Measure 8:** Soprano: "One", Alto: "One".
- Measure 9:** Soprano: "two", Alto: "two three four".
- Measure 10:** Soprano: "three", Alto: "five six".
- Measure 11:** Soprano: "four", Alto: "five six".
- Measure 12:** Soprano: "five", Alto: "five six".

Instrumental Details:

- Violins 1 & 2:** Violin 1 has a *mf* marking in measure 2. Violin 2 has a *mf* marking in measure 6.
- Viola:** No specific markings.
- Violoncello:** No specific markings.
- Contrabass:** No specific markings.

Rehearsal Markers:

- Marker 1:** Located at the beginning of measure 7.
- Marker 2:** Located at the beginning of measure 10.

[illegible]

21

K In 4 (same tempo)

S

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

One two three four five six se - ven eight nine ten

One two three four five six se - ven eight nine ten

The musical score is for a piece titled 'The Rose Tree' (K In 4, same tempo). It features vocal soloists (Soprano and Alto) and a chamber ensemble (Violins 1 and 2, Viola, Violoncello, and Contrabass). The score is in 4/4 time and begins with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The vocal parts have lyrics: 'One two three four five six se - ven eight nine ten'. The instrumental parts provide harmonic support, with the cello and contrabass playing a rhythmic pattern of eighth notes.

L

Mandarin

Hindi

S

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

26

ek do teen chār pānch che sāt āt no das ee ār

एक दो तीन चार पाँच छः सात आठ नौ दस — २

ek do teen chār pānch che sāt āt no das ee ār

एक दो तीन चार पाँच छः सात आठ नौ दस — २

S

A

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

31

sān sū oo lyo chee bā jyo shi

三 四 五 六 七 八 九 十

sān sū oo lyo chee bā jyo shi

三 四 五 六 七 八 九 十

Japanese

Soprano (S): ee - chee nee san yon go ro - koo shee - chee ha - chee

Alto (A): ee - chee nee san yon go ro - koo shee - chee ha - chee

Violin 1 (Vn. 1): *p* *f* *p*

Violin 2 (Vn. 2): *p* *ff*

Viola (Va.): *f* *p*

Violoncello (Vc.): *p* *f* *p*

Contrabass (Cb.): *f*

40

S

kyü jü eyns tsvey drây feer finf

九 十 一 二 三 四 五

A

kyü jü eyns tsvey feer finf

九 十 一 二 三 四 五

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

M

Yiddish

45

Hebrew

S

zeks zeebn ākht nāyn tsen ā - khāt shtāym shā - losh ār - bā khā - mesh

זַעֲקִס זֵיבֵן אֶכֶּט נֵיִן צֶען אַחַת שְׁתַּיִם שְׁלוֹשׁ אַרְבַּע חֲמִישׁ

A

zeks ākht nāyn tsen ā - khāt shtāym ār - bā khā - mesh

זַעֲקִס אֶכֶּט נֵיִן צֶען אַחַת שְׁתַּיִם אַרְבַּע חֲמִישׁ

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.



49

N Polish

S

shesh she - vā shmo - ne te - shā ē - ser ye - den dvā che chte - re pyench

שֵׁשׁ שֵׁשׁ - וָא שְׁמוֹ - נֵי תֵשֶׁה עֵ - סֵר יֵה - דֵּן דְּוָא צֵה צַחֵ - רֵי פִיעֵךְ

A

shesh she - vā te - shā ē - ser ye - den dvā che chte - re pyench

שֵׁשׁ שֵׁשׁ - וָא תֵשֶׁה תֵשֶׁה יֵה - דֵּן דְּוָא צֵה צַחֵ - רֵי פִיעֵךְ

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

English

54

S
shesht she - dem o - shem je - vench je - shench One two three four five
sześć sie - dem o - siem dzie - więc dzie - sięć

A
shesht she - dem o - shem je - vench je - shench One two three four five
sześć sie - dem o - siem dzie - więc dzie - sięć

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

p

58

S
six se - ven eight nine ten
ff 8 0

A
six se - ven eight nine ten
ff 0

Vn. 1
ff

Vn. 2
ff

Va.
(non div.)
ff *mf*

Vc.
(non div.)
ff

Cb.
ff

64

Vn. 1
mf

Vn. 2
mf

Va.
p

Vc.
p

78

Q

Italian

S

oo - no doo - e tre kwāt - ro cheen - qwe sey se - te

u - no du - e tre quat - tro cin - que sei set - te

A

āynz zvāy drāy veer fünf zeks zee - bin

eins zwei drei vier fünf sechs sie - ben

Vn. 1

Q

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

81

cresc.....

S

o - to no - ve dye - chi oo - no doo - e tre kwāt - ro cheen - qwe

ot - to nue - ve die - ci u - no du - e tre quat - tro cin - que

A

cresc.....

ākht noyn tsen āynz zvāy drāy veer fünf

acht neun zehn eins zwei drei vier fünf

Vn. 1

cresc.....

Vn. 2

cresc.....

Va.

cresc.....

Vc.

cresc.....

Cb.

cresc.....

English

84

S

six se - ven eight nine ten

A

six se - ven eight nine ten

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

ff

ff

ff

ff

ff

ff

p

p

p dolce

p

p



R French

89

S

uh dü twā kat sank sees set weet nuhf dees
un deux trois quatre cinq six sept huit neuf dix

A

uh dü twā kat sank sees set weet nuhf dees
un deux trois quatre cinq six sept huit neuf dix

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

R

f

f

f

f

f

f

f

f

f

94

Malay

S

sā - too doo - wā tee - gā uhm - pāt lee - mā uh - nām too - jo lā - pān suhm - bee - lān_ suh - poo - lo

sa - tu du - a ti - ga em - pat li - ma e - nam tu - juh la - pan sem - bi - lan se - pu - luh

A

sā - too doo - wā tee - gā uhm - pāt lee - mā uh - nām too - jo lā - pān suhm - bee - lān_ suh - poo - lo

sa - tu du - a ti - ga em - pat li - ma e - nam tu - juh la - pan sem - bi - lan se - pu - luh

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

98

S

Greek

p sub. *f* *p sub.*

e - nuh thee - yo tree - yuh te - se - ruh pen - te ek - see ep - tuh ok - to e - ney - uh

é - va dú - o trí - a téσ - σε - ρα πέν - τε έξ - ι επ - τά οκ - τώ εν - vé - α

A

p sub. *f* *p sub.*

e - nuh thee - yo tree - yuh te - se - ruh pen - te ek - see ep - tuh ok - to e - ney - uh

é - va dú - o trí - a téσ - σε - ρα πέν - τε έξ - ι επ - τά οκ - τώ εν - vé - α

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

English

110

S

One two three four five six se - ven eight nine

A

One two three four five six se - ven eight nine

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

Cb.

p

ff

molto rit.

114

ff

S

ten

f

p

Ooh

A

ten

ff

f

p

Ooh

Vn. 1

ff

f

p

Vn. 2

ff

f

p

Va.

p

Vc.

ff

f

p

Cb.

ff

f

p

attacca

III. Ella

Broadly, with reverence ♩ = 52

Soprano

pp

Ooh

Alto

pp

Ooh

Violin 1

Violin 2

Viola

Violoncello

Contrabass

rit.

f *pp*

(non div.)

f *pp*

f *pp*

solo

f *pp*

10 **U** a tempo *pp*

S El - la El - la El - la El - la El - - - la

pp *p* *pp*

A El - la El - la Ooh Soaked up all the sounds a - round her El - la Ooh Soaked up

U a tempo

Vc. solo *espr.*

17

S

rit. a tempo rit.

El - la El - la Ooh

A

p *pp* *pp*

all the sounds a - round her El - la El - la Ooh

Vc. solo

rit. a tempo rit.

tutti div.

(*pp*)

24 **V** a tempo rit. a tempo

S. *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la*

A. *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la* *El - la*

Vn. 1 **V** a tempo rit. a tempo
pp sotto voce

Vn. 2 *pp sotto voce*

Va. *pp sotto voce*

Vc. *sotto voce* *unis.*

Cb. *pizz.* *pp* *unis.*

The musical score is for a piece titled "The Rose Tree". It features a vocal solo section and a tutti section. The vocal solo section is marked "top voice solo" and "rit. al fine". The tutti section is marked "tutti" and "rit. al fine". The score includes parts for Soprano (S), Alto (A), Violin 1 (Vn. 1), Violin 2 (Vn. 2), Viola (Va.), Violoncello (Vc.), and Contrabasso (Cb.). The vocal parts have lyrics: "El - la", "El - la", "Ooh", and "mm". The instrumental parts include dynamics such as "non cresc.", "pp", and "ppp". The score is in 4/4 time and ends with a double bar line.

